

UNIT
69

U.S CONGRESS

CONVERSATION

Emily: Hey, did you see the news? That big infrastructure bill just passed the House of Representatives, and it actually looks like a serious effort to fix the roads and bridges.

Ryan: Yeah, now it heads to the Senate—where the real negotiation happens. It is the diverse priorities of the political parties that make this part take so long—everyone has their own agenda.

Emily: For sure. And then you've got lobbyists in the mix, pushing for changes behind the scenes, which just makes it even messier.

Ryan: Exactly. Lawmakers end up juggling party demands, lobbyists, and different drafts of the bill—just trying to get something that can actually pass. And even then, the president still has to sign it... or veto it and kick it back to Congress.

Emily: Right. But honestly, what matters most is if people actually notice better roads and bridges out of all this.

Ryan: Totally. At the end of the day, it's about whether the changes make everyday life easier.

Emily: Yep. All the back-and-forth only matters if it translates into something real for people.



VOCABULARY



House of
representatives



Representatives
(congresswoman/
congressman)



Senate



Senator



Lobbyist



Political parties



Bill



Sign a bill
into law



Veto a bill

LANGUAGE PRACTICE

Clefts



It was the Senate **that** passed the controversial bill after weeks of negotiation.

What really influences the outcome **is** the work of the lobbyists behind the scenes.



UNIT
69

U.S CONGRESS

EXERCISE 1

Complete the cleft sentences:

- A. The Congress passed a new environmental law. → It's was the Congress that passed a new environmental law.
- B. Lobbyists influence the lawmakers behind the scenes. It _____ who _____.
- C. The Senate approved the infrastructure bill. → It _____ that _____.
- D. The President can either approve a bill or reject it. → It _____ who _____.
- E. Lawmakers debated the bill for several weeks. → It _____ who _____.

EXERCISE 2

Complete the cleft sentences:

- A. The most important part of the bill is the funding for bridges. → What is most _____ important is the funding for bridges.
- B. Lawmakers need to negotiate the details carefully. → What _____ is _____.
- C. Lobbyists try to influence the outcome behind the scenes. → What _____ is _____.
- D. The President can sign the bill into law or veto it. → What _____ is _____.
- E. Political parties disagree on several points of the bill. → What _____ is _____.

SUMMARY

Type of Cleft	Normal Order	Cleft Version	Use
It-cleft	The Senate passed the healthcare bill.	It was the Senate that passed the healthcare bill.	Emphasizes the subject.
What-cleft	Lawmakers need to debate the bill thoroughly.	What lawmakers need to do is debate the bill thoroughly.	Highlights the key action.

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. It was the Congress that passed a new environmental law.
- B. It is the lobbyists who influence the lawmakers behind the scenes.
- C. It was the Senate that approved the infrastructure bill.
- D. It is the President who can either approve a bill or reject it.
- E. It was the lawmakers who debated the bill for several weeks.

Exercise 2

- A. What is most important is the funding for bridges.
- B. What lawmakers need to do is negotiate the details carefully.
- C. What lobbyists try to do is influence the outcome behind the scenes.
- D. What the President can do is sign the bill into law or veto it.
- E. What is controversial is the disagreement of political parties on several points of the bill.